



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

SEPTEMBER

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for October is
September 16

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



SEPTEMBER

SUNDAY WORSHIP - REGULAR SCHEDULE BEGINS SEPT. 18

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in September

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
				1 9a Fun & Fit.	2 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 6:30p RCA	3
4 Communion 10a One Service 7p SAA	5 Labor Day 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	6 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 6:30p Toastmasters	7 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 4p Methodicals 6:30p New Member Class 7p Children's Council	8 9a Fun & Fit. 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq	9 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 6:30p RCA	10 1:30p Girl Scouts
11 Patriot Day 9/11 Rally Day 10a One Service 6p Youth Night 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	12 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Finance 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p On this Spirit Walk	13 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 6p Nokomis Providers 6:30p Church Council	14 4p Methodicals 6:30p Youth Night	15 9a Fun & Fit. 10a Road by Walking 5:30p UMW Togo meeting	16 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	17
18 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 11a Worship with Band 1p Leadership Training 6p Youth & Confirmation 7p SAA	19 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p On this Spirit Walk 6:30p Women's Soul Group	20 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p UMW Leadership 6:30p Worship Committee	21 International Day of Peace 4p Methodicals 6:30p Confirmation	22 Fall Begins 9a Fun & Fit. 10a Road by Walking 5:30p Wedding Rehearsal 7p NAMI	23 Hicks Wedding 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	24 7a MinneHarvest
25 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 11a Worship with Band 6p Youth & Confirmation 6:30p Togo 7p SAA	26 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p On this Spirit Walk	27 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 7p SPR	28 4p Methodicals 6:30p UMW Simpson Meal Prep	29 UMW Simpson Shelter 9a Fun & Fit. 10a Road by Walking 6:30p Trustees & B+G	30 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	Notes: *Brighter Minds & Scouting schedule not available at time of printing *To avoid conflicts, please contact Heather BEFORE scheduling any events or meetings

Worship in September

We start the month with some one-service Sundays, and then move to our school-year schedule of 9:00 and 11:00 services inside. Sept. 4 is Labor Day weekend, and we'll be inside at 10:00. Then it is our kick-off to the program year with one service outside on Sept. 11 at 10:00 followed by a picnic, music, a bike parade, and general hanging-out time. We are going to be looking at different spiritual types this fall, because not all of us experience God or feed our souls in the same way. We will experience each of the four types through different style worship services each week. Of course, this will be broken up by some special events, but we'll get to them all by the end of October. Sept. 18 will be the first exploration as we look at the first of our spiritual types, "Kingdom" spirituality which focuses on being able to do things for others and make the world a better place. On Sept. 25 we'll confirm 2 of our 10th graders and celebrate the ending of the confirmation program (but not the ending of connection to the church!) for all of our 10th graders.

4th	"At the Wheel" <i>One Service at 10:00 am, Rev. John Darlington preaching</i>	Jeremiah 18:1-6; Luke 14:25-28
11th	"Spiritual Types" <i>Rally Day Service outdoors at 10:00 am</i>	Luke 15:1-10
18th	"Kingdom Spirituality" <i>Regular schedule begins. 9:00 worship with organ and choir, 10:00 education and fellowship, 11:00 worship with band.</i>	Jeremiah 8:18-9:1
25th	"The Word of God Brings Hope" <i>Confirmation Sunday</i>	Jeremiah 32:1-3a, 6-15

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

- Sept. 4 10:00 One Service (Labor Day Weekend)
- Sept. 11 10:00 One service outside; Welcome Sunday
- Oct. 15 Harvest Dinner
- Oct. 29 Will Party
- Oct. 29 Halloween Party
- Nov. 12. Holiday Bazaar



We hosted a NEBA concert featuring Princeton and Symone Brown on August 13



You can
Seek, Serve, and Celebrate
while helping others to
Seek, Serve, and Celebrate

Join the Minnehaha Faith Formation Team!

The 2016-2017 program year kicks off on Sunday, September 11th, and continues through May. For us to have a successful program, we need volunteers.

We need volunteers of all ages, with openings in programs for all ages. We need people who'd like to commit on a weekly basis, and people who want to help out on limited, seasonal projects.

We need people who want to lead classes, and people who want to support those leaders.

We need the whole community.

Please consider how you might be a part of this team.

Name: _____

Email or Phone Number (however you prefer contact): _____

_____ Yes, I am interested. Please contact me to see how you can match my particular skills, interest, and availability with the needs of our Faith Formation program.

_____ Hmm, I am intrigued but not entirely certain. Please contact me to see if there's a way I might be able to help the team.

_____ Not this year. Please don't contact me.

Anything you'd like us to know ahead of time:

Children's Ministries

We've reached the point in the summer when stores' selection of school supplies is beginning to be picked over, when Halloween catalogues have begun arriving in the mail, when the anticipation of a new school year incites all sorts of emotional responses in children, parents, teachers - all those involved in the world of education.

It is - like New Year's - a time for beginnings, for fresh starts, for reflections and goal settings. As we anticipate all that is to come, we are challenged by this Minnehaha community, and by our faith, to consider how we will make time in our lives for seeking, serving, and celebrating.

What do we do in our lives to create a space for ourselves, our children, and our family all together to explore what it means to be a Christian? What do we do in our lives to ensure that we are taking seriously the call to love one another?

At Minnehaha, we hope to be able to help you get started on the right foot for this new school year. With opportunities for you to explore your faith and spirituality, to consider how you connect and grow in relationships with others, and to serve your community: we want to help make space in your lives for God's love. We hope you will join us throughout the year - for Sunday morning worship and faith formation, for social events and Bible studies, for plays and playgroups, meals and work days and more.

REGISTER NOW for Sunday School online by going to the church's website (www.minnehaha.org) and following the links.

Families with preschoolers are invited to join us for a Preschool Open House on Wednesday, August 31st from 5:30 to 7pm to learn about the Faith Formation Program and see their classroom.

The kick-off for all Sunday School classes will be at Rally Day - Sunday, September 11th with one worship service at 10am. At the end of this service, children will meet their teachers, take a class picture, and spend a bit of time in their classroom. At the close of all of this, there will be a bike parade, picnic lunch, and other activities. We hope to see you there!

Please feel free to contact us with any questions - and also to let us know how we can better support you as a faith community.

We look forward to a wonderful 2016-2017 Program Year!

Jenia Strom

Director of Children and Family Ministries
education@minnehaha.org/612.721.6231

MUMC Youth Activities for September

Sept. 11th - Rally Sunday: Youth in 6th-12th Grade (10:00am-2:00pm)

- Worship service starts at 10am, followed by meeting our Sun. school teachers and Youth serving lunch!
- Please join us for a fantastic kick-off to the fall! All proceeds of the lunch help support our Youth program.

Sept. 11th - Youth Night Kick-off Pizza and planning party: Youth in 6th-12th Grade (6:00-8:00pm)

- Join us for pizza and help us plan the ways we will Seek, Serve, and Celebrate this year!

Sept. 18th - Confirmation Night: Youth in 6th-12th Grade (6:00-7:30pm) 3rd Floor Youth room

- Theme: History of Christianity

Sept. 25th - Confirmation Night: Youth in 6th-12th Grade (6:00-7:30pm) 3rd Floor Youth room

- Theme: What about other denominations?



Minnehaha Playdate
 For Children 5 & Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

at
Minnehaha United Methodist Church



Highlights from the August 9, 2016 Church Council Meeting

ON TRACK WITH CHURCH BUDGET: According to our Finance Chair (Sue Claude) and Treasurer (Dennis Feller), our finances are looking good right now. Since the beginning of the year, we've retired more than \$64,000 in long-term debt. So the amount we owe on the building project and Reisdorph (Annex) addition is down to \$435,738. (And that's with the oil tank removed!) Pledges are coming in on schedule, all bills have been paid, and apportionments and

interfund loan payments have been made through July 31, 2016. Thank you! (Sue Claude, Finance Chair; Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

HCI STRATEGIC PLANNING MOVES FORWARD: The Strategic Plan for the church (developed through the Healthy Church Initiative) is moving ahead, with the team meeting monthly and advancing several things you'll see over the next few months, including:

Promote the church's vision: "We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate."

Print Minnehaha UMC T-shirts featuring the new logo (available soon!)

Encourage everyone in the church to read a chapter a week of "We Make the Road by Walking" by Brian McLaren (Becky has copies for \$5.00 each) starting September 12

Leadership training for all committee members to help them better understand their gifts and interests (3 Sundays from 1-4: September 18, October 16 and November 20)

Survey the congregation on their talents and interests

Reimagine the set-up of the Narthex to make it more inviting and welcoming

UPCOMING STEWARDSHIP CAMPAIGN: Initial work for the 2017 Stewardship campaign has begun. The team of Chris Kramer, Jefferson Slinkard and Matt Zimmerman will return as leaders. Once again our goal is to achieve a balanced budget and support the programs and missions of Minnehaha UMC. (Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

ROOM RENTAL INFO AVAILABLE ON WEBSITE: If you, your family or group wants to rent a room in the church, information about rooms, capacity, and rates are now available on the church website (www.minnehaha.org). On the home page, look for the section called "Work Orders, Kitchen Info and Building Use," click on the link, and you'll see links to info about Work Orders, Room Rental Information, Facility Use Application, Building Use Guidelines, Kitchen Rules and Kitchen Rental. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

FOOD SHELF SERVES 567 CLIENTS: Last month, the Minnehaha Food Shelf (which is housed at the church) served a total of 567 clients: 337 adults, 161 children and 78 seniors. Thanks for your support of this important mission! (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

NEW GIVING ENVELOPE FOR FOOD SHELF & MINNEHARVEST: You'll find a new envelope in the pews on Sunday mornings. It says "Support the Food Ministries" and provides information about our two key food missions: Food Shelf and MinneHarvest. You write in your gift amount, put in a check or cash, and mail or drop the envelope into the offering plate. This should make it easier support these missions, and help folks who are food insecure. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Coordinator; Sheldon Bolstad, MinneHarvest Coordinator)

PIANO REPLACEMENT AND ORGAN REPAIRS: The grand piano in the Sanctuary has a large crack that cannot be repaired (at a reasonable cost). But former members the Hillers have offered to donate their grand piano to the church... we just need to pay moving costs and make a few adjustments. Along with that, some repairs need to be made to our valuable church organ. So the church is trying to raise \$2,500 to cover these costs. If you'd like to contribute, place a check in the offering plate and indicate that it's for: Organ/Grand Piano Special Appeal." Thanks! (Kim Kanuit, Trustees)

NEXT MEETING SEPTEMBER 13 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for September 13 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Sunday Morning Adult Faith Forums

This year in the Adult Faith Forums held on Sunday mornings we will explore the concept of sanctuary; not the room in which we worship, but rather the protection provided by a safe place. How can we create and maintain a safe place where we live in faith, not fear; hope, not despair; love, not judgment. Each week we will use the scripture reference being studied by the children in their Sunday school program to guide us on our journey of offering sanctuary to one another. And perhaps in the act of offering sanctuary to others we will find sanctuary for ourselves. For more information, contact Paul Minehart.

Prayer and Fasting for a Healthier Minnehaha Community

This fall Nicolas Sabah will lead all who are interested in two days of prayer and fasting. Many in our community are experiencing health issues. Our prayers and fasting will be for the health of our Minnehaha community. Our prayers and fasting will be in all areas of health: physical, spiritual, mental, financial. We will fast from 6:00 am to 6:00 pm on a Saturday and Sunday with a focus on prayers for the health of Minnehaha. For more information, contact either Beth or Paul Minehart.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on September 8.

NAMI

NAMI of Hennepin County, part of an organization dedicated to building better lives for people affected by mental illness, will be holding a "Listening Session" in the Minnehaha UMC Fellowship Hall at 7:00 pm on Sept 22.

This listening session will be an opportunity for consumers of mental health services, family members and other interested parties to speak their minds regarding ways MH programs and services could be improved, as well as needs which are not being met.

A report on the 2015 Listening Tour can be viewed at www.namihennepin.org (click on "More").

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church
invites you
and your family
to our**

Faith Formation Open House

When: Wednesday, 31st August; 5:30-7pm

Where: Preschool Room (rm. 202) at Minnehaha

Who: All Families with Preschool Age (3 & 4 year olds)

Children for the 2016-2017 Program Year

What: A chance to visit the Sunday School space and to learn about our Faith Formation programs.

At Minnehaha, we strive to help children develop curiosity about their faith, and to give them opportunities to seek, serve, and celebrate God's love in an intergenerational and inclusive setting.

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org, 612.721.6231**

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries, at education@minnehaha.org

Adult Classes

On This Spirit Walk

A new 12-week class will begin on Monday evening, September 12 from 6:30-8:00. This study was created especially for United Methodists and was written by a Native American in collaboration with a member of the United Methodist Church who has worked extensively with Native American communities. We will be focusing on Native American tradition through our World Communion Sunday in October, and this is a wonderful opportunity to spend some time learning more about Native American spiritual culture and the connections to Christianity and to the United Methodism in particular. You will need to have the book *On This Spirit Walk* by Henrietta Mann & Anita Phillips for the class, so if you would like Becky to order it for you, please let her know prior to the first class. We will be reading a chapter each week (the chapters are short). You may also just go online (try Cokesbury.com where the book is sold for \$15) and order it yourself.

We Make The Road By Walking

We are trying a new thing this program year, encouraging the whole church to read a book together. It is meant to be read as a community, with questions for conversations among a household of all ages. To help us in this endeavor, we will also be discussing the chapter we are reading each week on Thursday mornings from 10-11. The books will be handed out during worship on Sunday, September 11 at our one service. If you aren't able to be in worship that day, talk to Becky to get your book in advance. Read the reflection for that week (they are all short), and come to class on Thursday morning for the conversation. This book will be our topic through December 15.

Adults Wanted For Youth Programming

Programming for youth is taking on a new look this fall. Rather than meeting twice a month on Wednesday nights, we are going to meet every Sunday night from 6-7:30. There will be youth nights once a month for all 6-12 graders, and the rest of the weeks we will have separate programs for 6-7 graders, 8-9 graders (which will be confirmation) and 10-12 graders (which is still pending). The first gathering will be September 11, and it will be a youth night. If you would like to be an adult volunteer, we could use another adult to help out in the 6-7 and in the 8-9 grade programs, and we are also looking for at least 2 adults to lead the 10-12 grade group. Just contact Becky Sechrist or Lani Thompson if you are interested.

Leadership Training

Leadership happens in a variety of ways, and we want to encourage more of it. We know that people lead in their jobs, in their communities, in their families, and at church. It isn't just a thing done in a committee, but we are beginning by offering a 3-part leadership training this fall for all people serving on committees. We'll explore personality types through inventories like the Myers-Briggs, talk about practical things like communication and conflict resolution, and also do some spiritual exploration as well. The goal is to offer this training each year, and to open it up in future years to anyone interested. For now, though, if you are on a committee, please come to the trainings on Sept. 18, Oct. 16, and Nov. 20. All of them will be at the church, and all will be held from 1:00-4:00 in the afternoon. Please RSVP either yes or no to Becky Sechrist right away.



We worshipped at the Falls August 7

One Service Sundays

We will be having one service on two upcoming Sundays:
September 4 – one service inside at 10:00. Labor Day Weekend.

September 11 – one service outside at 10:00 for our program year kick-off. There will be food for sale, a bike parade, music, and other fun events following the service.

Financial Update – First Six Months 2016

As summer wanes, now is a good time to provide an update on Minnehaha United Methodist Church's financial position. Last night (I write this on August 9) – we had another in a series of short, uneventful MUMC Finance Committee meetings. As we wrapped up the meeting, Becky reminded us that short, uneventful Finance Committee meetings are a sign of an organization on solid financial footing. Here is where we are today, and where I project we will be at year-end.

SUMMARY: *Right now MUMC is in a good financial position, with income slightly ahead of budget and expenses slightly below budget. If trends continue, we should meet our goal of a balanced budget by the end of the year.*

*I want to **THANK** the members and friends of MUMC. Your generous contributions of time, money and prayer have blessed us with a solid first 6 months in 2016. With your continued support, we can enter 2017 on a firm foundation.*

Have Questions? *Contact Sue Claude, Finance Chair, or Dennis Feller, Treasurer*

GENERAL FUND*: We've had seven consecutive months in which:

1. The General Fund has had a surplus.
2. All our financial obligations have been paid on time.
3. The cash flow has been positive. (All good things.)

Also, I want to highlight that we have paid our conference apportionments every month, and I expect that at year-end we will have paid our 2016 conference apportionments in full and be "forgiven" for our unpaid obligations from 2012.

Performance to Budget. The budget that the membership approved at the January Annual Meeting was a **balanced, lean but realistic budget**. As all budgets are – it was based on our best forecast of the coming year's income and expenses. Especially important was the commitment demonstrated by our members and friends in the \$15,000 Matching Gift Challenge. The success of that campaign allowed us to ratify a balanced budget without cutting staff.

Income – Contributions Above Plan. At the end of June, our contributions were up about \$12,000 compared to what we might expect if donations came in evenly throughout the year. However, donations typically fall off in the summer months and then swing up in the fall. (We observed this in June and July.) As a result, I expect that this financial "cushion" will erode slightly as we move into the second half of the year, and that contributions will be as forecasted and budgeted at year-end.

Expenses – Below Plan. Our staff and committees have controlled expenses so we are running slightly below what we budgeted at the beginning of the year. As many of you have witnessed at home, natural gas expenses have been lower, although this has been partially offset by increased electric costs. Nonetheless, our utility expenses are down, which is saving us money.

Second Half Forecast. Dennis Feller, our Treasurer, projected that we will end the year even: with our expenses matching our income. (Which is ultimately the goal with a balanced budget.) We also predict that we will be able to effectively manage our cash flow in the second half of the year. If you recall, in October 2015 we had a combined budget performance/cash flow issue that prompted the Blue Mug Special Appeal. There is no reason to think we will repeat it this year.

BUILDING FUND*: Although I'm pleased with the General Fund – I'm over the moon with our performance against the church mortgage. As you are aware, this spring we consolidated and refinanced our mortgage through Thrivent Financial. As a result, we were able to secure a 15-year loan with a very competitive (and much lower) interest rate. We entered 2016 with combined building/land loans over \$498,000. At the end of June 2016, our debt obligation was below \$438,000. (Down a whopping \$60,000!). We still hold 6 months of minimum principal and interest payments in reserve, but our plan is to apply any surplus contributions to principal so the mortgage can be paid off as soon as possible. As part of the refinancing project, we needed to make a decision on our underground oil storage tank. Thanks to the hard work of Trustees, the oil tank was removed and as a result, we no longer have this potential future financial and environmental liability.

The Building Fund is paid through Capital Campaign contributions. (Separate from general budget contributions.) If you didn't pledge in the 2015 Capital Campaign – know that additional contributions are always welcome. Just clearly state on the check or giving envelope that your donation should go to the BUILDING FUND, so it doesn't mistakenly get directed to the General Fund or another dedicated account.

Financial Update continued from page 9

DEDICATED FUNDS*: These accounts are not funded in the General Fund but through designated contributions or special fundraisers. Recently, we have had a number of special appeals for some of these dedicated accounts, like the Minnehaha Food Shelf, MinneHarvest and the unbudgeted Organ/Piano Repair. I'm happy to report that church members have generously responded to these special requests. My hope is that we will not need to have any additional appeals for our dedicated funds this year.

Other highlights: Timely distribution of funds going to organizations outside MUMC such as UMCOR (the United Methodist Committee on Relief), Imagine No Malaria and Simpson Housing Services.

-submitted by Sue Claude, MUMC Finance Committee Chair

* Definitions:

General Fund: The General Fund supports the infrastructure and general missions of the church and the 2016 budget is \$420,000. The majority of these funds are used to 1) pay staff and support the church office (60%), 2) pay for our church facilities, utilities and maintenance (19%), and 3) pay conference apportionments (12%). The primary income streams include 1) donations (80%), 2) facilities rental (9%) and 3) fundraisers (4%).

Building Fund: The Building Fund is a **dedicated** account with the sole income being contributions associated with our capital campaign and additional designated donations. The income is used to pay off the church mortgage that funded the \$1.085 million Building and Remodeling project that commenced in 2010. We also had private loans to purchase the adjacent Reisdorph (Annex) property and tear down the house on the property. We ended 2014 with \$523,656 worth of combined loans. At the end of 2015 we had \$498,193 worth of combined debt obligations.

Dedicated Funds: We have a number of additional dedicated funds that hold funds in reserve for the express purpose designated by the contributor or an exclusive fundraiser. These funds might support specific spiritual formation or missions of the church locally, such as Youth Activities, Contemporary Band, Food Shelf or MinneHarvest. Or they might be funds donated through the church to support the activities and missions outside MUMC. These might be regional organizations like Simpson Housing Services, or international organizations like UMCOR. In the cases in which the organization is outside the church, we issue checks transferring the contributions to them. What is unique about these is that these funds are donated for the express purpose of these groups and that the funds are used exclusively by those groups and carry over from year to year.

United Methodist Women

Please plan to attend our meeting on Thursday, Sept. 15 to learn about the church group from Togo who meet here at Minnehaha UMC. We will begin with a potluck dinner in the Fellowship Hall at 5:45 and enjoy a talk from Rev. Sabah following the dinner. All church members are invited to come!

Get on board with a Circle this fall! UMW Circles are groups of women who meet monthly to enjoy each others' company and discuss their faith and community. There are two day Circles: Minnehaha Circle meets at church on the first Wed. of the month at 1:00 (contact Bev Pederson or Jan Hougen) and the Nokomis Circle meets on the second Wed. of the month at Nokomis Square at 9:30 a.m. (contact Joann Becklund). Susanna Circle meets on Thursday evenings, usually at church; for more info, contact Jenia Strom. Winona Circle meets when we need to prepare for special events that we host in our Fellowship Hall along with an annual Christmas potluck and dinner in June; to get on the email list to help out, contact Kim Kanuit. All Circles are open to any women of our congregation, whether you are a member or not. There are also general meeting during the day in December and March.

We will again be serving dinner at Simpson Shelter this year; please save these dates to help out: Oct. 20, Dec. 20, March 21, and May 22. We will need help on those evenings to serve the meals beginning at 5:45 and ending at 8:00 but we also need folks to prepare the meals the day of or the day before. Please let Maureen Trepp (612-724-7620) know soon if you are willing to help with this mission.

Annual Holiday Bazaar

by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

A Redbird Christmas

Saturday, November 12, 2016

9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m.

Gifts, Crafts, Fine Art, Antiques, Collectibles, Food and more!

BREAKFAST
9:00 – 11:00 a.m.
Egg Bake, Cinnamon Rolls

LUNCH
11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.
Hot Dish, Sloppy Joes, Dessert Table

CHILDREN'S BOUTIQUE
9:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.
Fun gifts for children to select, wrap and give their parents at Christmas time.



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Rain, Rain Go Away

There have been some rather spectacular rainstorms around Minnesota of late. We know that any local weather event is just that, a local weather event. Trends and patterns over time make up climate. And scientists are telling us that one of the

ramifications of climate change is what we are experiencing locally – more extremes in rainfall and temperature. We might still get 1” of rain in a week, but instead of being spread out over a day, it comes in half an hour. Or we get heavy downpours for awhile followed by a long period of no rain at all, swinging from flash floods to drought in a relatively short period of time. It’s hard to look out our windows at the rain coming down in buckets and not think about climate change, or be aware of how other parts of the country (and world) have been without rain for so long.

And all of that is appropriate. It is appropriate to notice that our rains are getting more extreme. It’s appropriate to notice that rain is not distributed across geography the way it used to be. It’s even appropriate to pray for the climate, for those with too much rain and those without enough. It’s appropriate to pray that I can change my own behavior so that I’m not continuing to contribute to the factors that bring about climate change.

What I don’t want to do, though, is lose my sense of the beauty and wonder of rain. I remember as a teenager praying for occasional days of rain. Not because we needed it, but just because I loved it. As a Minnesotan who can feel trapped inside during the winter, I felt like every beautiful day that could be spent outside should be spent outside. If we had a long run of beautiful days, I would start to ache for an excuse to just sit inside for awhile and not be outside riding my bike or playing in the yard or walking around the neighborhood or swimming, or the many other things that could only be done outside. I wanted to be able to just sit in a chair and read a book or write or draw. I know those things can be done outside too, but it seemed a waste of summer to do anything that could also be done inside. And so I looked forward to rainy days.

Some of that is still in my blood, I guess, because when it rains, I want to run to the window and look with wonder at the raindrops coming down the glass, and then fetch a good book and curl up in a chair for awhile. Maybe even make a cup of tea or pop some popcorn.

This desire to sit still periodically is part of my spiritual life as well. I certainly include my morning dog walks as time of prayer, and there is much in the world to be admired through travel. I can see the spirit of God in the faces of those I see when I’m volunteering at MinneHarvest, and I can pray for those in need while shopping for school supplies or making food to serve at Simpson Shelter. But I also encounter God in the drops of rain that run down a window, and in the story or information of a good book. I even encounter God in a cup of tea. I like living in Minnesota in part because our seasons can be extreme. I like the variety of ways in which my soul is fed by the changing of the natural world and by the opportunities and people I encounter. So, next time it rains, feed your soul a little. Make a cup of tea and grab a book. Or pull up the covers and take a long nap. Maybe even go out and dance in some puddles. Wherever you encounter God, however you are reminded of God’s presence, soak it in, just like the ground soaks in a long gentle rain, storing up what it needs for whatever is around the next bend.

In joy,

Becky





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9/16



A decorative banner with a red string and several colorful pennants (yellow, blue and white checkered, yellow, red with a white circle, and blue and white checkered) hangs diagonally across the page.

Save the Date for Rally Day: Sunday, 11th September

Join with members of the Minnehaha United Methodist Church community as we celebrate the beginning of a new program year.

One Worship Service Outside at 10am

Followed by:

- **Meeting & Greeting Sunday School Teachers**
- **A bike parade and lawn games**
- **All-Church Lunch**